
DANIEL ANCUTA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering leader who scales distributed teams and stays hands-on with the hardest problems. 20+ years building production systems; 7+ years leading distributed engineering organizations (up to 90 engineers across 17 countries) in regulated healthcare environments (FDA, HIPAA, GDPR, COPPA).

Steps into critical delivery gaps personally — including rewriting a backend-for-frontend layer integrating several downstream services from TypeScript to Python in 5 days to save a major release — and drives organization-wide technical change, from leading API governance efforts to driving AI-tooling adoption across engineering. Leads by shipping alongside the team, not just directing it.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BACKEND ENGINEERING TEAM LEAD

LIVANOVA (MEDICAL
DEVICES - DIGITAL HEALTH)

January 2024 - Present
Remotely (UK)

Part of the Leadership Team (VPs, Senior Directors) directing delivery and architecture for the company's Digital Health Platform, coordinating priorities across distributed backend, frontend, system engineering, and DevOps teams spanning multiple time zones.

Owns API governance for internal (REST) and external (GraphQL + REST) interfaces used across the whole platform, and leads organization-wide adoption of AI-assisted engineering practices (code review automation, reusable best-practice guides, training, governance).

ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Rescued a major platform release by personally rewriting the backend-for-frontend layer — which integrates with several downstream services — from TypeScript to Python in 5 days, including test coverage, after identifying it as the critical risk to the deadline; then led the team that closed the remaining gaps
- Unified delivery across Cloud, Backend, QA, Data, DevOps, and Architecture teams for that release, replacing scattered spreadsheets and disconnected boards with a single tracked backlog and communication channel
- Resolved a 200+ field data-contract mismatch between a companion mobile app and the platform's backend models by aligning specifications and generating strictly-validated models, eliminating silent data corruption
- Led the platform's API governance effort: treating OpenAPI specs as source of truth, generating typed models directly from them, and adding automated schema validation in CI, closing a long-standing gap between spec and implementation
- Drove adoption of AI-assisted code review and developer tooling across the engineering organization, including a reusable library of internal best-

practice guides and a way to run AI coding agents safely in an isolated local sandbox (open-sourced)

- Redesigned the technical hiring pipeline, introducing AI-assisted take-home assessments, and hired 7 senior/lead engineers to close a critical skills gap on the backend team
- Rebuilt the team's local development environment into a full end-to-end stack (frontend, backend, mobile, and hardware), adopted by multiple engineering teams beyond his own
- Modernized a legacy digital health platform that had gone two years without dedicated engineering investment: led a security and infrastructure review, implemented GDPR-driven data-deletion flows, and cut hosting costs 20%, with a plan to exceed 50%
- Scaled the distributed backend department to 90 people across 17 countries

www: LivaNova.com

BACKEND ENGINEERING TEAM LEAD

LIVANOVA (MEDICAL
DEVICES - DIGITAL HEALTH)
- WORK ON EPSY HEALTH
PLATFORM

January 2023 - January 2024

Remotely (UK)

Member of a technology leadership team for Epsy Health platform, responsible for driving delivery and architectural direction for backend.

ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Built Data Lake with AWS Glue and S3, enabling ML capabilities through SageMaker and centralizing frontend, backend, and mobile analytics
- Aligned backend priorities with business objectives through strategic technical roadmap, improving stakeholder visibility and delivery predictability
- Designed recruitment, onboarding, and offboarding processes supporting rapid team scaling
- Reduced operational expenses by \$122,000 annually through FinOps practices while promoting cost-awareness across engineering teams
- Strengthened platform security through GitHub Enterprise governance and standardized microservice templates
- Upskilled team through AWS training programs, resulting in multiple new AWS certifications
- Achieved COPPA compliance including identity verification capabilities
- Initiated SOC2 certification preparation
- Established Service Operation Centre with Squadcast, CloudWatch, Sentry, and Linear, reducing incident response times

www: EpsyHealth.com

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

LIVANOVA (MEDICAL
DEVICES - DIGITAL HEALTH)
- WORK ON EPSY HEALTH
PLATFORM

August 2020 - January 2023

Remotely (UK)

Responsible for developing backend services for EpsyHealth, a digital platform for people with epilepsy, caregivers, and healthcare providers managing epilepsy, including Infrastructure as Code (IaC) and CI/CD pipelines.

AWARDS:

- [2020 Google Material Design Awards](#)
- 2021 Innovation by Design award (Fast Company)
- Lifetime 4.7* rating on both Android and iOS stores, from over 4000 individual reviews

ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Accelerated feature delivery by 50% by migrating Flask monolith to event-driven microservices, improving platform resilience for growing user base
- Improved platform's stability by migrating user database from PostgreSQL to Amazon Cognito, simplifying authentication and improving cross-platform mobile user experience
- Enabled seamless offline-online experience for epilepsy patients using AWS Amplify and AppSync, delivering real-time sync across mobile and web
- Expanded platform to EU and UK markets through GDPR-compliant multi-region deployments, meeting data residency requirements

www: EpsyHealth.com

BACKEND ENGINEERING TEAM LEAD

LIFEWORKS - TELLUS
HEALTH (EMPLOYEE
WELLBEING)

February 2019 - August 2020
Remotely (UK)

Led backend engineering team (technical leadership and line management) delivering multiple parallel projects for Employee Assistance Program.

ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Upskilled PHP team to Python proficiency through structured training, enabling successful transition to AWS-based microservices development
- Migrated on-premise monolith to AWS event-driven microservices for EAP platform, reducing costs and enabling predictable delivery
- Redesigned interview and onboarding processes with structured criteria, supporting rapid backend team expansion

www: lifeworks.com

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

LIFEWORKS - TELLUS
HEALTH (EMPLOYEE
WELLBEING)

June 2018 - February 2019
Remotely (UK)

Hired to lead technical transition from monolithic PHP application to cloud-native microservices architecture using AWS and Python, for LifeWorks, an Employee Assistance Program platform used globally by millions of users.

ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Improved system performance and data isolation by migrating critical datasets from monolithic to microservice architecture
- Unified CI/CD pipelines with Bamboo across backend and frontend teams, accelerating deployment cycles and standardizing delivery practices
- Reduced new service setup time from days to hours with internal bootstrapping tool automating infrastructure, monitoring, and deployment provisioning

www: lifeworks.com

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

THREADS STYLING
(ECOMMERCE)

September 2017 - February 2018

Threads Styling is a personal shopping platform specializing in luxury products.

Working closely with Head of Engineering as a hands-on contributor on migrating legacy app (Ruby + Rails + on-premise) to Python and AWS.

ACHIEVEMENTS:

Remotely (UK)

- Designed Elasticsearch schema enabling fast full-text search across gigabytes of WhatsApp customer conversations for luxury shopping platform
- Enhanced personalization through Elasticsearch migration, delivering improved customer insights and data-driven shopping recommendations

www: ThreadsStyling.com

LEAD SOFTWARE ENGINEER

FLUBIT (ECOMMERCE)

January 2015 - September 2017

London, UK

Led architecture design and strategic planning for e-commerce marketplace platform. Drove cloud migration strategy and technical roadmap for scaling operations.

ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Developed AWS cloud migration strategy for e-commerce platform, delivering technical roadmap, cost-benefit analysis, and risk mitigation plans
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SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

FLUBIT (ECOMMERCE)

April 2014 - January 2015

London, UK

Working closely with CEO, product owners and technical teams (frontend, data science) on delivering Flubit's e-commerce marketplace platform.

ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Designed Elasticsearch schema enabling fast search across 60 million products, improving customer discovery experience
- Built event-driven indexing with RabbitMQ processing 700 updates/second, maintaining real-time product availability and pricing accuracy

www: flubit.com

EARLY CAREER EXPERIENCE (2007 - 2014)

Software Engineer | SensioLabs UK (Software House) | October 2012 - April 2014 | London, UK

Contributed to digital transformation projects for enterprise clients including TalkTalk and feelunique.com. Introduced engineering best practices through training and pair-programming, modernizing platforms to support product delivery at scale.

Software Engineer | Komputronik S.A (Ecommerce) | November 2009 - January 2012 | Poland

Developed bespoke e-commerce applications for one of Poland's largest electronics retailers, supporting multiple brands and markets across Poland and Czech Republic.

Software Contractor | Self-employed | February 2008 - October 2012 | Poland

Delivered PHP/MySQL solutions across multiple companies and projects as an independent contractor.

PHP Developer | CD PROJEKT (gog.com) | September 2007 - February 2008 | Poland

Contributed to the development of GOG.com, a DRM-free digital distribution platform for classic video games.

TECHNICAL SKILLS:

LEADERSHIP & MANAGEMENT:

- **Cloud & Infrastructure:**
 - AWS Services: Amplify, AppSync, Redshift, Glue, Lambda, DynamoDB, EventBridge, SNS, SQS, ECS, ECR, API Gateway, Athena, Streams, Cognito, Secrets Manager, CloudWatch, Step Functions and many more
 - IaC: Terraform, Pulumi
 - Containers: Docker
 - System's configuration: Vagrant, SaltStack, Chef
 - Frameworks: Serverless Framework, AWS Cloud Formation
 - Microsoft Azure
- **Programming & Frameworks:** Python (Flask, Bottle, Chalice, FastAPI, pydantic, pytest), TypeScript, PHP (Symfony), PL/SQL, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Oracle Database
- **Architecture & Patterns:** Microservices, REST, GraphQL, Event-driven systems, Data Lake architectures, TDD (phpspec), BDD (Behat), API Governance (spectral)
- **Data & Search:** Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ
- **DevOps & CI/CD:** GitHub Enterprise, GitHub Actions, Git, SonarCloud, Snyk, Datadog, Bamboo
- **Productivity & Collaboration:** Jira, Linear, Slack
- **Monitoring & Incident Response:** Squadcast.com, Datadog, Pingdom
- **Feature Management & Experimentation:** LaunchDarkly.com
- **Customer Engagement & Analytics:** Segment.com, Amplitude.com, Customer.io, Singular.net, AppsFlyer.com
- **Compliance, Privacy & Identity Management:** OneTrust.com, GDPR, HIPAA, Children's Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA), Veriff.com
- **Customer Support, CRM & Service Management:** Salesforce, Zendesk
- **Frontend & UI Libraries:** React, jQuery, Prototype, MooTools
- **AI:** OpenAI API (GPT-5, GPT-4 and previous models), Anthropic API (Claude), MCP, Amazon Q
- **Team Leadership:** 7+ years leading distributed cross-functional engineering teams (Backend, Frontend, Mobile, DevOps), technology leadership, strategic technical planning
- **People Management:** Line management, goal setting, yearly performance reviews, career development, mentorship & coaching, team scaling
- **Talent Acquisition:** Recruitment strategy, hiring processes design, interview process optimization, structured onboarding/offboarding, team expansion
- **Methodologies:** Agile, Scrum, iterative delivery, process improvement
- **Budget & Operations:** FinOps practices, cost optimization, resource allocation, operational expense management
- **Collaboration:** Cross-functional coordination, stakeholder management, alignment with product owners & business priorities
- **Training & Development:** Team upskilling programs, AWS certification initiatives, knowledge transfer, technical presentations

PUBLICATIONS:

- [AI Agents in Your CI/CD: Why GitHub Rulesets Matter Now More Than Ever](#)
- [Claude Compose Sandbox: Flexible Docker Environment for AI Agents](#)
- [Building a full CLI tool with spec-kit \(spec-driven development\) and Claude \(AI\)](#)
- [From Bug Fixes to Full Features: Building React Applications with Claude Code](#)
- [Refactoring Massive OpenAPI Specs with Claude](#)

Code

- [AI: Improve your prompt with AI](#)
- [Serving static pages on AWS with Amplify](#)
- [Protect Sensitive Data in Logs with AWS CloudWatch Data Masking](#)
- [GitHub Actions: Security Hardening With OpenID Connect](#)
- [Secrets Management in AWS: Using Secrets Manager](#)
- [GitHub Rulesets: Your Safeguard for Your Repositories](#)
- [Update AWS CloudFront configuration using AWS CLI](#)
- [Streaming GitHub audit log to S3 with OpenID Connect - Troubleshooting](#)
- [AWS Amplify Override Amplify-generated resources. On example with resolvers.](#)
- [Protocol Buffers RPC calls through WebSockets on AWS Lambda with API Gateway](#)
- [Error tracking and incident response on production with Sentry + Squadcast + Linear + Slack](#)
- [Strategies to Migrate Users to AWS Cognito Pool](#)

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